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(54) **TODDLER WALKER WITH INTERACTIVE
DISPLAY DEVICE HAVING MULTIPLE
ADJUSTMENT MODES**

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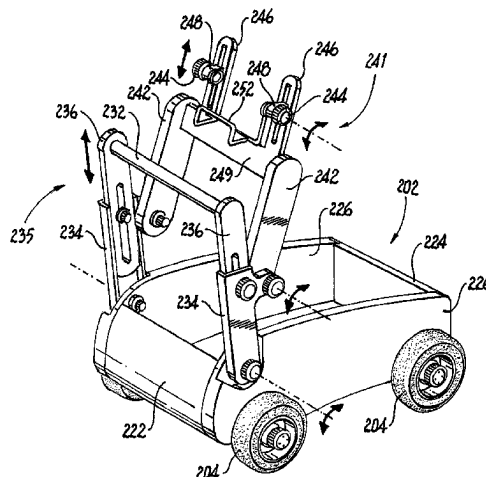
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B62B 5/067; B60B 33/0086; B60B
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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A toddler walker having a body comprising a bottom panel,
and a front panel, a rear panel, and a pair of side panels
attached to the bottom panel so as to form an open box; at
least four wheel assemblies, each comprising a wheel rotat-
ably affixed to the body so that when the wheels rotate the
body moves via the wheels along a surface; a handlebar
assembly comprising a handlebar, means for adjusting the
handlebar to a desired vertical position, and a pair of leg
channels pivotally connected to the side panels to enable a
toddler to grasp said handlebar assembly when located
behind the body and direct movement of the body along the
surface; and a display device assembly pivotally connected
to the handlebar assembly and comprising means for remov-
ably attaching a display device further comprising means for
adjusting the height of the display device.

4 Claims, 6 Drawing Sheets



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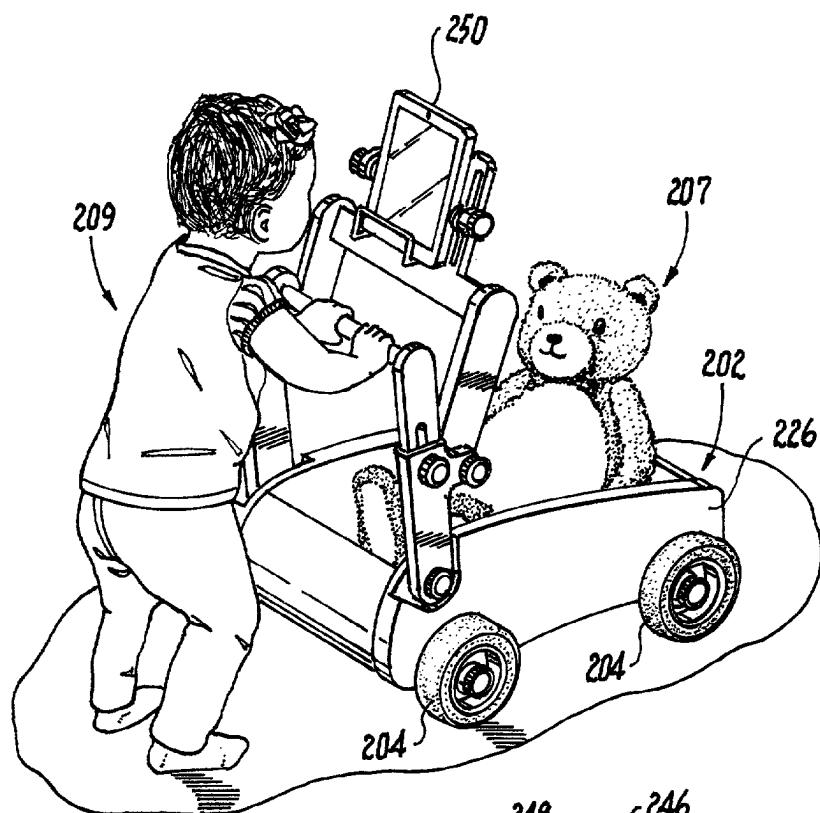


Fig. 1

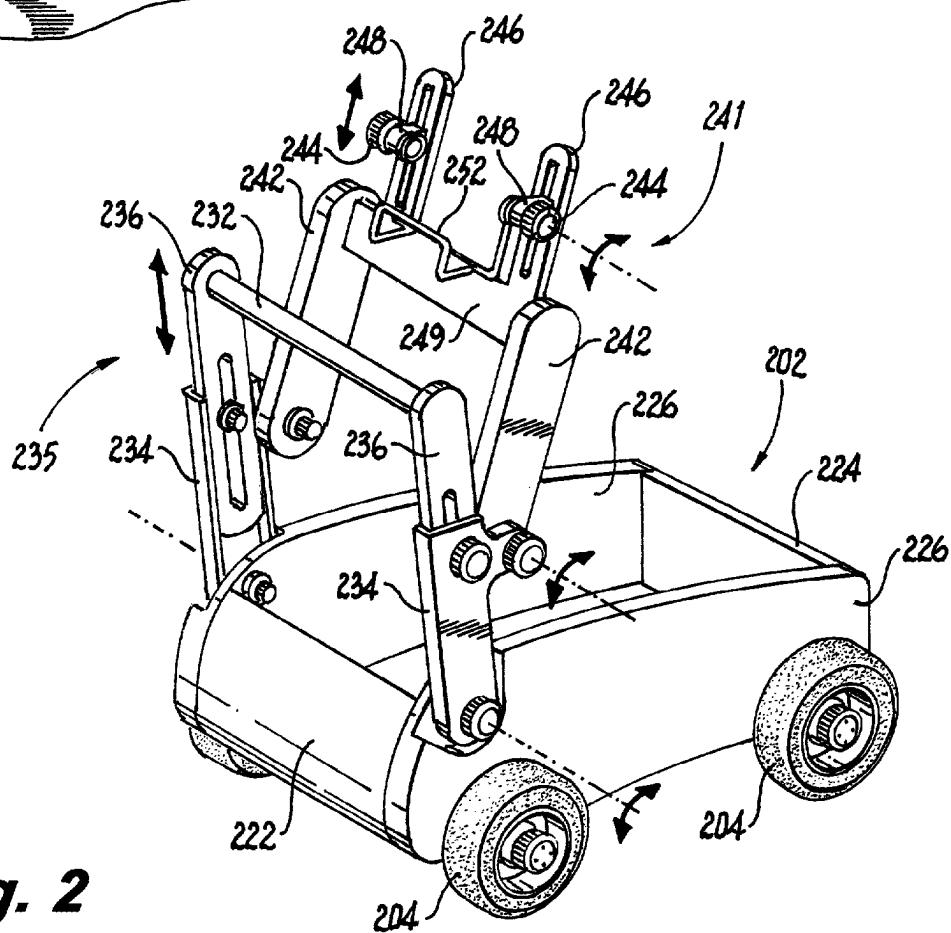


Fig. 2

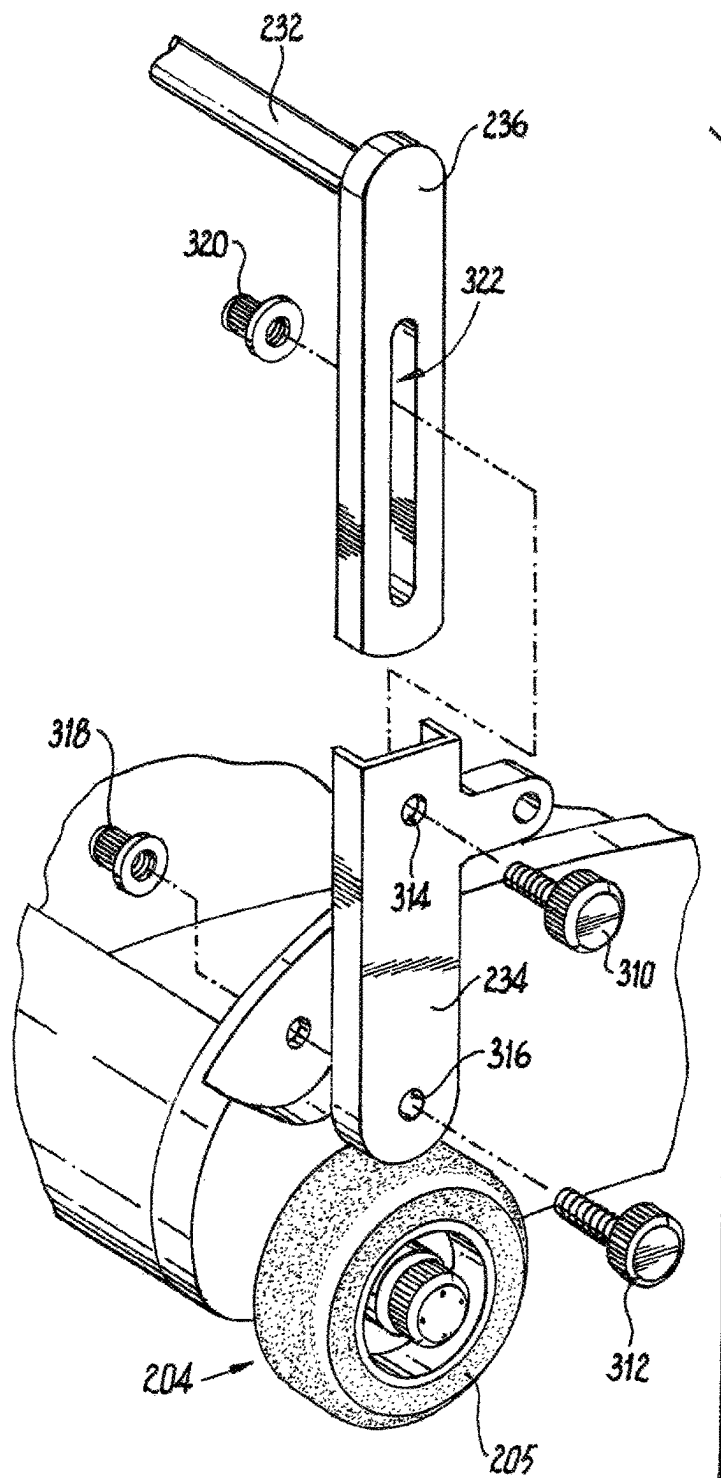


Fig. 3

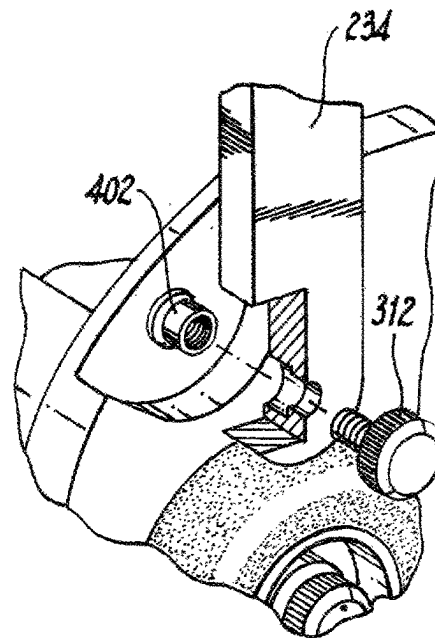


Fig. 4

Fig. 5

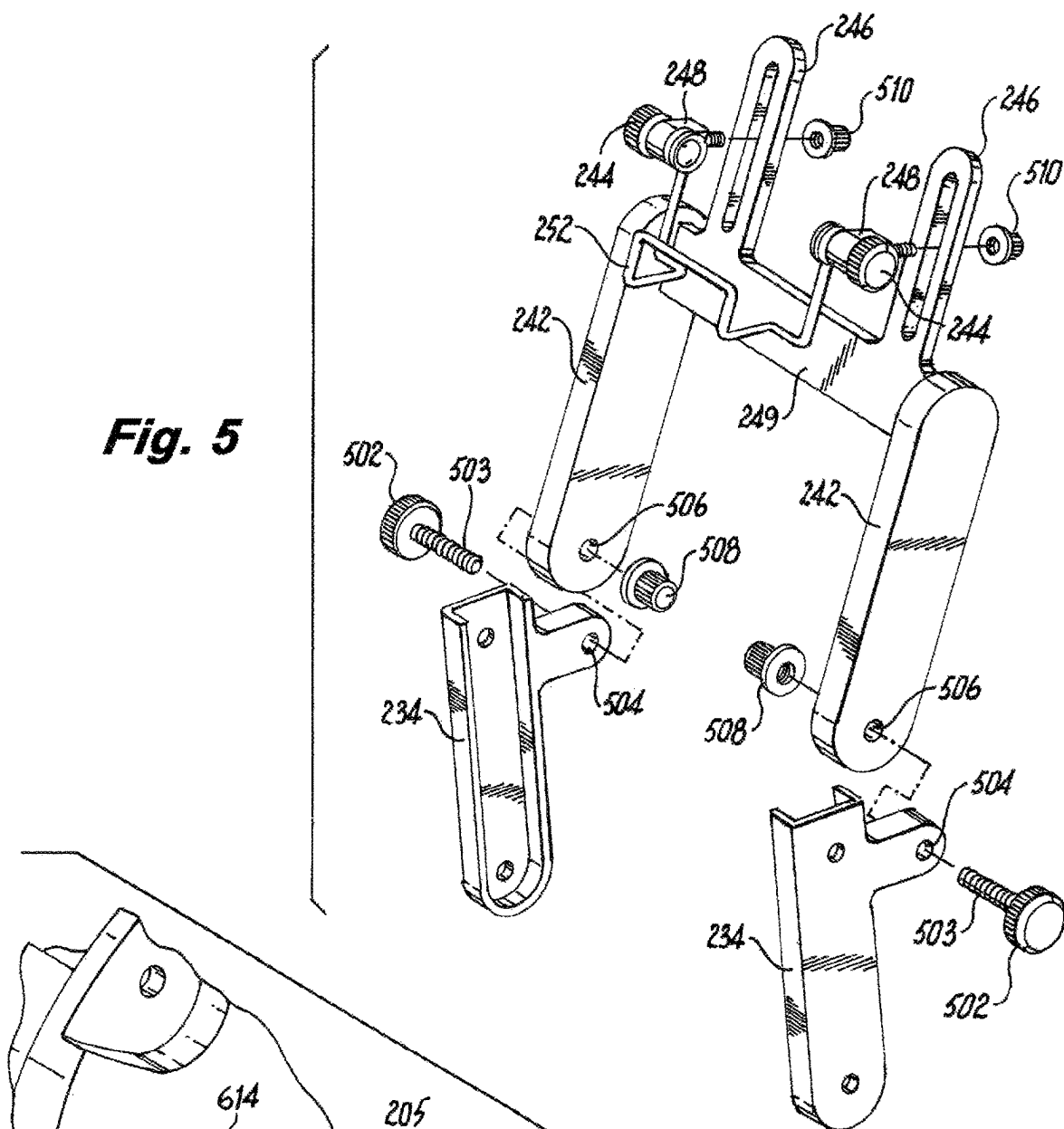


Fig. 6

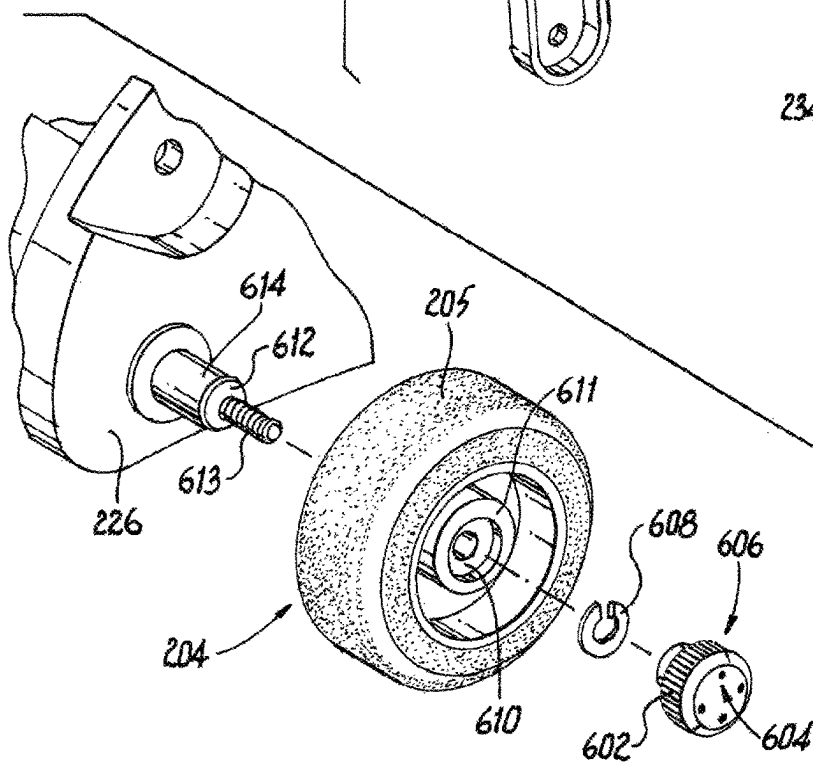


Fig. 7

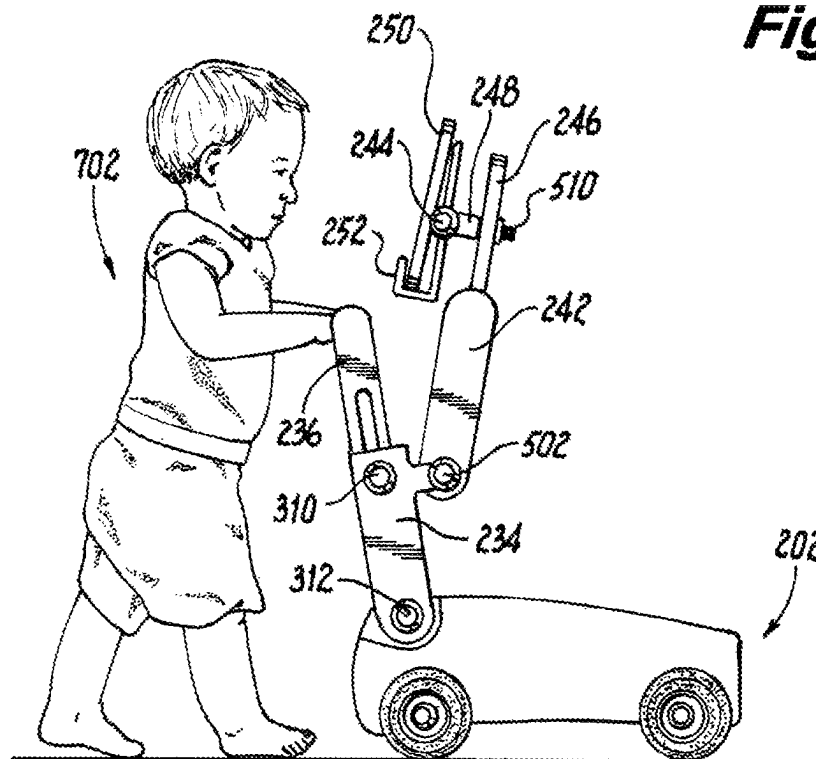
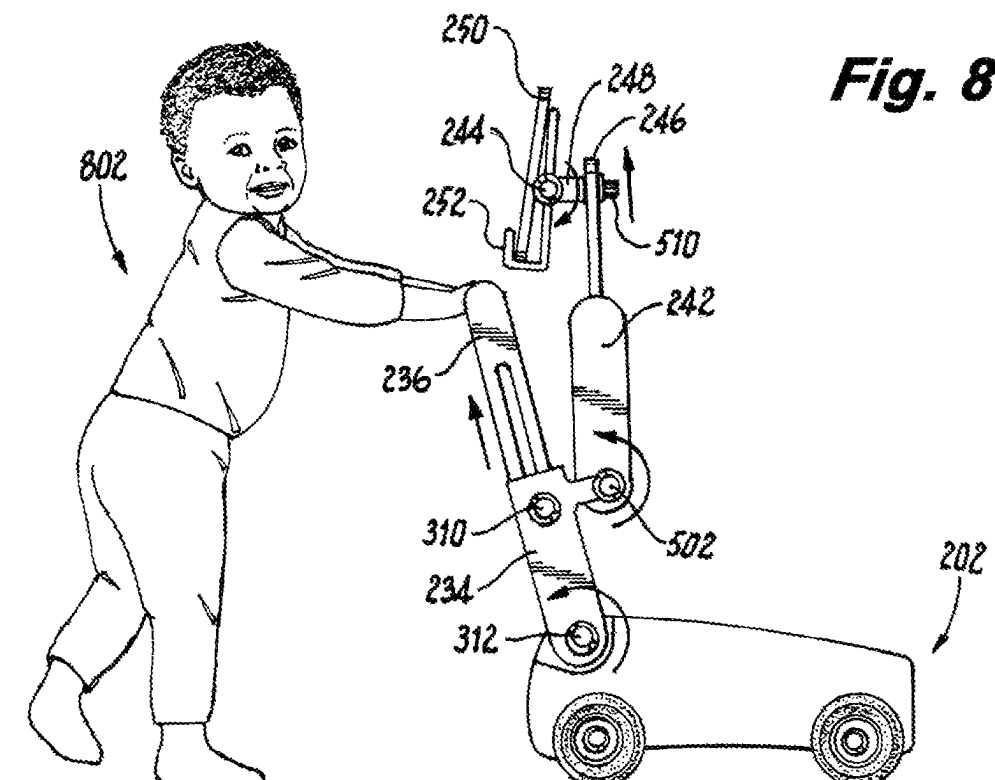


Fig. 8



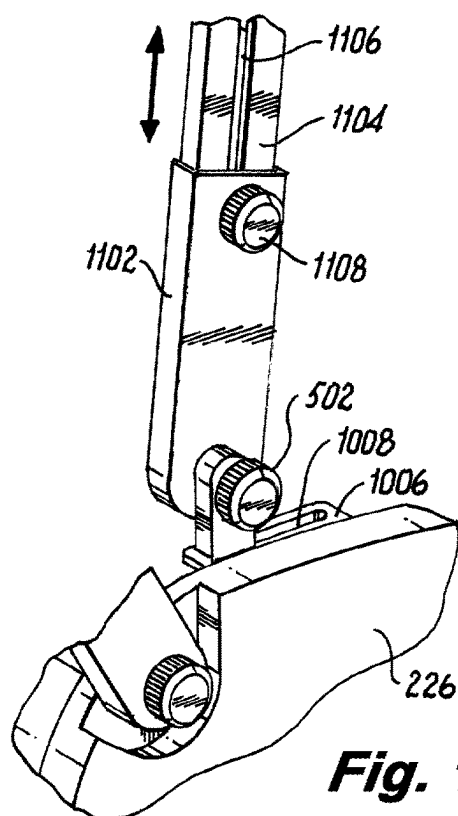
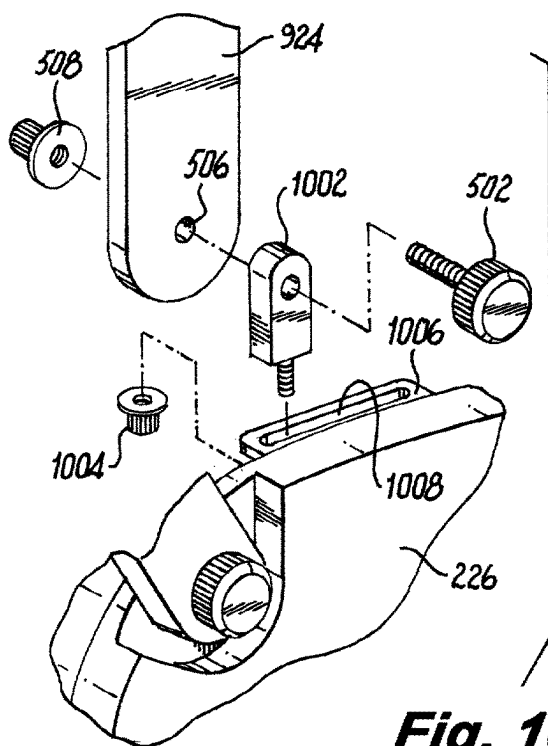
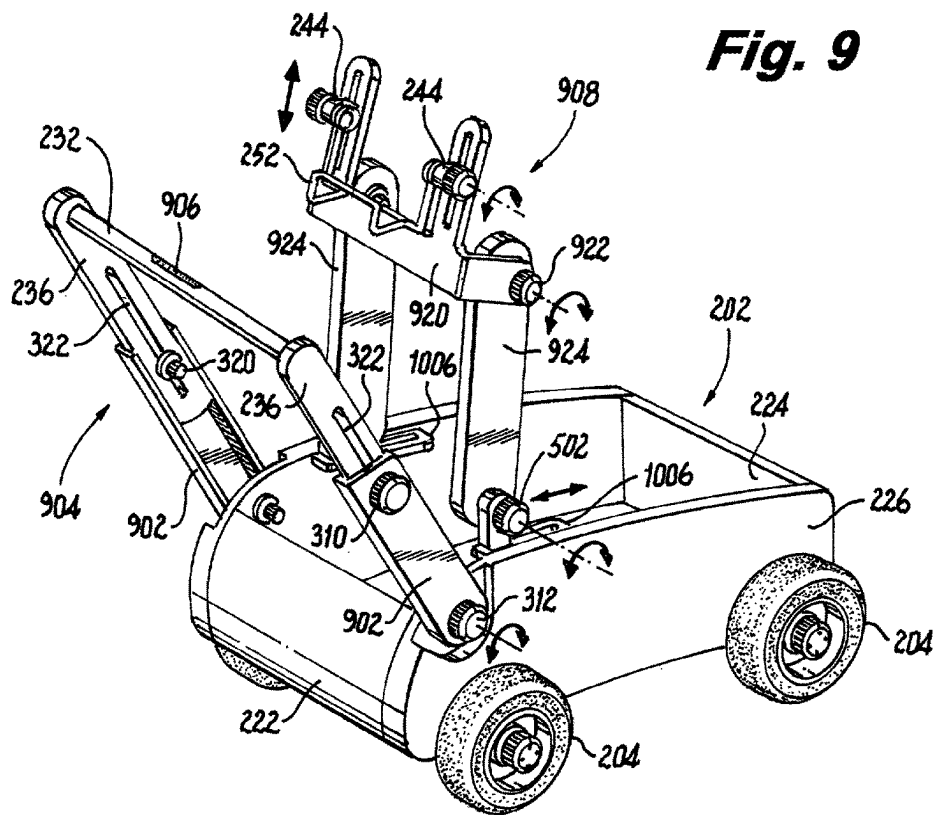


Fig. 12

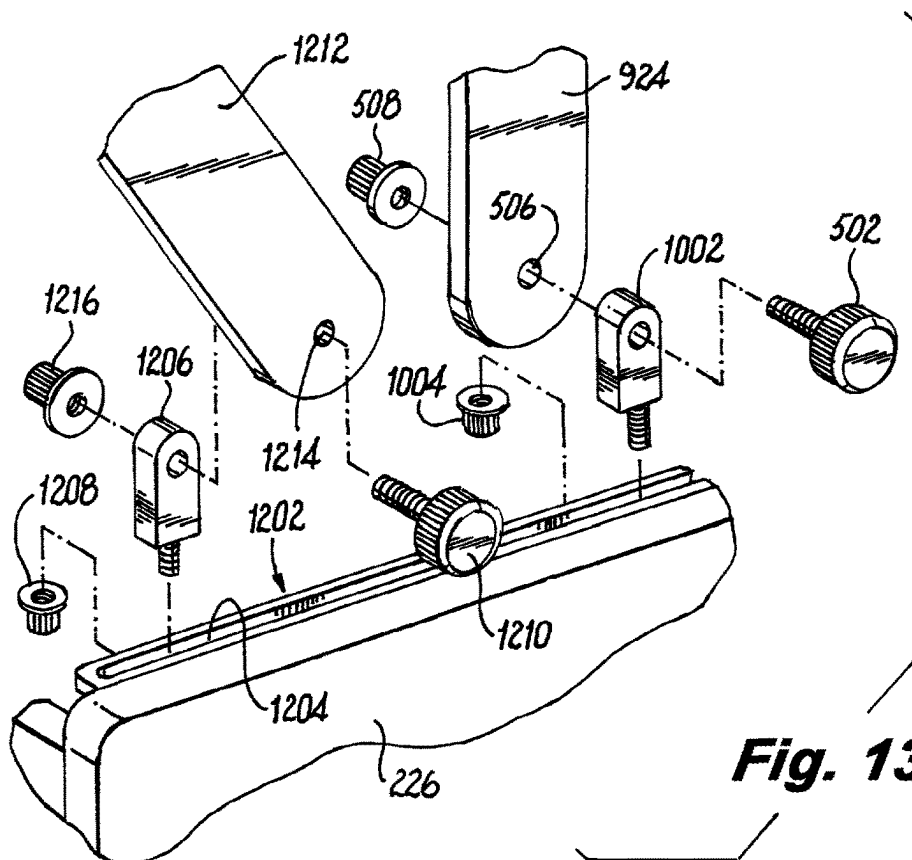
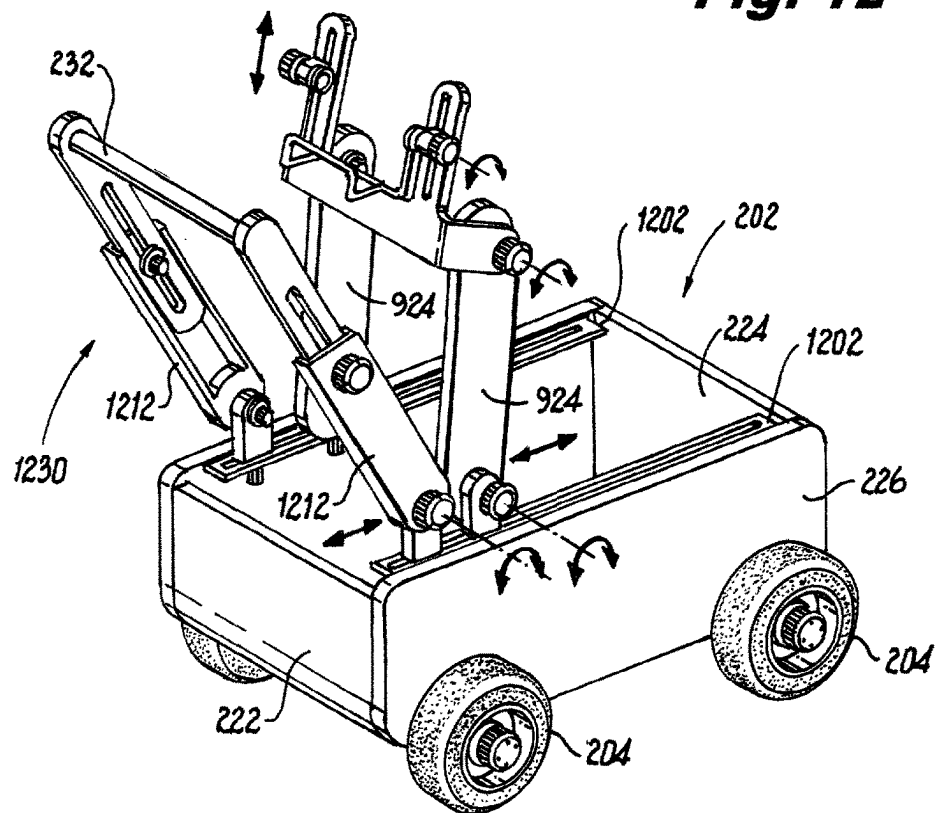


Fig. 13

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TODDLER WALKER WITH INTERACTIVE DISPLAY DEVICE HAVING MULTIPLE ADJUSTMENT MODES

TECHNICAL FIELD

This application relates to a device that assists a toddler in learning to walk, and in particular to such a device having an interactive display device, wherein multiple adjustment modes are provided for increased suitability to the particular stage of development in which the toddler is learning to walk.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Devices exist which assist toddlers (e.g., 1-2 year olds) in learning to walk. These devices, referred to herein as toddler walkers, may exist in different forms, but in general include a body and four wheels, and a handle suitable for the toddler to hold onto while he or she begins to walk. The walker provides a stable vehicle that the toddler can lean on as they take their first steps, eventually enabling the toddler to gain the balance, strength, and confidence to walk on their own without relying on the walker.

These existing walkers do not, however, account for differences in size, strength, or dexterity of the toddler, or where they may be on the developmental curve with respect to learning to walk unassisted. For example, a toddler who is just starting to learn to walk has different needs than one who is close to walking unassisted. The prior art walkers may either be too difficult for a beginning walker, and/or too easy for a more experienced walker. Additionally, these walkers lack the ability to provide engagement of the toddler with the walker through, e.g., an interactive display device or the like.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

Provided herein is a toddler walker, which in a first embodiment includes a body which has a bottom panel, and a front panel, rear panel, and two side panels attached to the bottom panel so as to form an open box. At least four wheel assemblies are provided, each including a wheel rotatably affixed to the body so that when the wheels rotate the body moves via the wheels along a surface. A handlebar assembly is provided with a handlebar, means for adjusting the handlebar to a desired vertical position, and a pair of leg channels pivotally connected to the side panels, to enable a toddler to grasp the handlebar assembly when located behind the body and direct movement of the body along the surface.

A display device assembly is pivotally connected to the handlebar assembly and has means for removably attaching a display device for display to the toddler as they direct movement of the walker along the surface, including means for adjusting the height of the display device.

Each wheel assembly of the toddler walker includes a hub having a hub recess centered therein. The wheel of each wheel assembly is rotatably affixed to the body with an axle attached to the side panel, wherein the axle has a threaded portion. The wheel is coupled to the axle by inserting the threaded portion of the axle through the hub recess such that the hub rests against a bearing surface of the axle. A knob is threaded onto the threaded portion of the axle to maintain the wheel rotatably on the axle.

Each wheel assembly may also include means for adjusting the tension of the wheel such that the wheel may be set to require a desired amount of strength to push the walker

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along the surface. For example, the means for adjusting the tension of the wheel may include a lock washer inserted onto the threaded portion of the axle between the hub and the knob, wherein the lock washer provides biasing so that tightening the knob urges the lock washer against the hub to increase friction against the hub and require increased strength to push the walker along the surface. The wheel assembly may also have a label including graphics indicating the position of the knob with respect to the wheel, thus enabling each wheel to be easily set to the same tension as the others.

Each leg channel of the handlebar assembly is slidably connected to a slotted member, with the handlebar being connected at each end to the slotted members. The means for adjusting the handlebar to a desired vertical position may include a bolt inserted through an aperture on the leg channel and a slot in the slotted member, with a nut attaching to the bolt to hold the slotted member in sliding relation to the leg channel. Loosening the nut from the bolt allows the slotted member to be raised or lowered in relation to the leg channel and tightening the nut to the bolt retains the slotted member with respect to the leg channel.

In one aspect, the handlebar assembly is pivotally connected to the side panels with a bolt inserted through an aperture in each leg channel and a mating aperture in the side panel. A nut attaches to each bolt to hold each leg channel in pivoting relation to the side panel. Loosening the nut from the bolt allows the leg channel to be pivoted in relation to the side panel to a desired angular position and tightening the nut to the bolt retains the leg channel with respect to the side panel.

Alternately, the handlebar assembly is pivotally connected to the side panels with a bolt inserted through an aperture in the leg channel and threaded into a tapped insert affixed in the side panel. Loosening the bolt from the tapped insert allows the leg channel to be pivoted in relation to the side panel to a desired angular position and tightening the bolt to the tapped insert retains the leg channel with respect to the side panel.

The display device assembly may include a crossbar connected at each end to one of a pair of legs, wherein each of the legs is pivotally connected to the handlebar assembly with a bolt inserted through an aperture in each leg channel of the handlebar assembly and a mating aperture in each leg. A nut attaches to each bolt to hold each leg in pivoting relation to the leg channel. Loosening the nut from the bolt allows the leg to be pivoted in relation to the leg channel to a desired angular position and tightening the nut to the bolt retains the leg with respect to leg channel.

The means for removably attaching a display device for display to the toddler as they direct movement of the walker along the surface may include a device bracket for removably holding the display device. The device bracket has a pair of threaded device mounts oppositely disposed to removably hold the display device, and a pair of locking knobs, each of the locking knobs threadably engaging each threaded mount whereby the position of each of the threaded mounts can be selectively adjusted to accommodate differently sized display devices.

The means for adjusting the height of the display device may include a pair of nuts for removably securing each of the threaded mounts to the crossbar through a slotted upright attached to the crossbar. The device bracket may be raised or lowered in relation to the crossbar and the nuts may be used to secure the device bracket in a desired vertical position on the crossbar.

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In a second embodiment, the toddler walker is similar to the first embodiment and includes a body which has a bottom panel, and a front panel, rear panel, and two side panels attached to the bottom panel so as to form an open box. At least four wheel assemblies are provided, each including a wheel rotatably affixed to the body so that when the wheels rotate the body moves via the wheels along a surface. A handlebar assembly is provided with a handlebar, means for adjusting the handlebar to a desired vertical position, and a pair of leg channels pivotally connected to the side panels, to enable a toddler to grasp the handlebar assembly when located behind the body and direct movement of the body along the surface.

However, in this second embodiment, the display device assembly is slidably connected to the side panels and has means for removably attaching a display device for display to the toddler as they direct movement of the walker along the surface, including means for adjusting the height of the display device. Each side panel has a slotted bracket with a slot for receiving therethrough a mount with a threaded stud, wherein a nut is threaded onto the threaded stud to secure the mount to the slotted bracket.

Also, in this second embodiment, the display device assembly has a crossbar attached at each end to one of a pair of legs, wherein each of the legs is pivotally connected to the side panels with a bolt inserted through an aperture in each leg and a mating aperture in the mount secured to the side panel. The bolt is secured with a nut and holds each leg in pivoting relation to the mount. Loosening the nut from the bolt allows the leg to be pivoted in relation to the mount to a desired angular position and tightening the nut to the bolt retains the leg with respect to the mount.

In this second embodiment, the display device assembly has means for pivoting the crossbar in relation to the legs, which may include a bolt inserted into an aperture in the crossbar and a mating aperture in the leg, the bolt being secured by a nut. The crossbar may be pivoted in relation to the legs to provide the desired angular position of the display device.

In a third embodiment, the toddler walker is similar to the first and second embodiments, and has a body which has a bottom panel, and a front panel, rear panel, and two side panels attached to the bottom panel so as to form an open box. At least four wheel assemblies are provided, each including a wheel rotatably affixed to the body so that when the wheels rotate the body moves via the wheels along a surface. A handlebar assembly is provided with a handlebar, means for adjusting the handlebar to a desired vertical position, and a pair of legs slidably and pivotally connected to the side panels to enable a toddler to grasp said handlebar assembly when located behind the body and direct movement of the body along the surface.

In this third embodiment, the display device assembly is slidably connected to the side panels and has means for removably attaching a display device for display to the toddler as they direct movement of the walker along the surface, including means for adjusting the height of the display device.

Furthermore, in this third embodiment, each side panel has a slotted rail with a slot for receiving therethrough a mount with a threaded stud, wherein a nut is threaded onto the threaded stud to secure the mount where desired along the slotted rail. A pair of legs are slidably and pivotally connected to the side panels with a bolt having a threaded portion inserted through an aperture in each leg and a mating aperture in each mount, the threaded portion of the bolt

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being secured with a nut. Thus, the leg pivots in relation to the mount and the mount slides in relation to the slotted rail.

Notably, the entertainment and attention getting factor provided by the child's favorite video program presentation on the display device including familiar music, characters and learning animation is the key factor in increasing attention and commitment to by the child to working with the device.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWING

FIG. 1 is a top perspective view of a first embodiment of a toddler walker with a toddler grasping the handlebar while simultaneously viewing media displayed on a display device mounted thereon.

FIG. 2 is a top perspective of the embodiment of FIG. 1, showing the independent adjustability for rotation and length of the handlebar mount, and rotation and height for the display device bracket.

FIG. 3 is an enlarged local perspective view of the handlebar support members of the first embodiment of FIG. 1 in a parts-separated condition.

FIG. 4 is a local perspective view of the first embodiment of FIG. 1 with parts separated of an alternate fixturing means for the handlebar support members showing a tapped receiver.

FIG. 5 is a top perspective view with parts separated of the display device support members of the first embodiment of FIG. 1.

FIG. 6 is a local perspective view with parts separated showing the components for tensioning the wheels in the first embodiment of FIG. 1.

FIG. 7 is a side elevation of the toddler walker of FIG. 1 adjusted for use by a toddler having a smaller stature.

FIG. 8 is a side elevation of the toddler walker of FIG. 1 adjusted for use by a toddler having a larger stature.

FIG. 9 is a top perspective view of a second embodiment of a toddler walker having a display device mounting which is independent of the handlebar mounting and is slidably adjustable.

FIG. 10 is a local perspective view of the second embodiment of FIG. 9 with parts separated of the components of the display device mount.

FIG. 11 is a local perspective view of the second embodiment of FIG. 9 showing a display device mount having height adjustability in addition to sliding capability.

FIG. 12 is a top perspective view of a third embodiment of a toddler walker having independent sliding capability for both the handlebar mount and the tablet mount.

FIG. 13 is a local perspective view of the third embodiment of FIG. 12 with parts separated of the components for both the handlebar mount and the tablet mount.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

As described herein, FIG. 1 is a top perspective view of a first embodiment of a toddler walker with a toddler grasping a handlebar while simultaneously viewing media displayed on a display device mounted thereon, and FIG. 2 is a top perspective of the embodiment of FIG. 1, showing the independent adjustability for rotation and length of the handlebar assembly, and rotation and height for the display device assembly, as now described in further detail.

The first embodiment of the toddler walker as shown in FIGS. 1 and 2 includes a body 202 which has a bottom panel (not shown), and a front panel 224, a rear panel 222, and two

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side panels **226** attached to the bottom panel so as to form an open box-like structure. This enables a toddler **209** that is using the toddler walker to carry items such as toys **207** in the walker. At least four wheel assemblies **204** are provided, which as further shown in FIGS. **3** and **6** each including a wheel **205** rotatably affixed to the body **202** so that when the wheels **205** rotate the body **202** moves via the wheels along a surface.

A handlebar assembly **235** is provided with a handlebar **232** and a pair of leg channels **234** pivotally connected to the side panels, to enable the toddler **209** to grasp the handlebar assembly **235** when located behind the body **202** and direct movement of the body along the surface.

Means are also provided for adjusting the handlebar **232** to a desired vertical position, wherein the leg channels **234** are each slidably connected to a slotted member **236**, with the handlebar **232** being connected at each end to the slotted members **236**. As shown further in FIG. **3**, the means for adjusting the handlebar to a desired vertical position include a bolt **310** inserted through an aperture **314** on the leg channel **234** and a slot **322** in the slotted member **236**, with a nut **320** attaching to the bolt **310** to hold the slotted member **236** in sliding relation to the leg channel **234**. Loosening the nut **320** from the bolt **310** allows the slotted member **236** to be raised or lowered in relation to the leg channel **234** and tightening the nut **320** to the bolt **310** retains the slotted member **236** with respect to the leg channel **234**.

Referring again to FIG. **2**, a display device assembly **241** is pivotally connected to the handlebar assembly **235** and has means for removably attaching a display device **250** for display to the toddler **209** as they direct movement of the walker along the surface.

FIG. **6** is a local perspective view with parts separated showing the components for tensioning the wheels in the first embodiment of FIG. **1**. Each wheel assembly **204** includes a hub **611** having a hub recess **610** centered therein. The wheel **205** of each wheel assembly **204** is rotatably affixed to the body **202** with an axle **614** attached to the side panel **226**. The axle **614** includes a threaded portion **613**. The wheel **205** is coupled to the axle **614** by inserting the threaded portion **613** of the axle through the hub recess **610** such that the hub **611** rests against a bearing surface **612** of the axle. A knob assembly **606** including a knob **602** is threaded onto the threaded portion **613** of the axle **614** to maintain the wheel **205** rotatably on the axle.

Each wheel assembly **204** may also include means for adjusting the tension of the wheel such that the wheel may be set to require a desired amount of strength to push the walker along the surface. For example, the means for adjusting the tension of the wheel may include a lock washer **608** inserted onto the threaded portion **613** of the axle between the hub **611** and the knob **602**, wherein the lock washer **608** provides biasing so that tightening the knob **602** urges the lock washer **608** against the hub **611** to increase friction against the hub and require increased strength of the toddler to push the walker along the surface. The wheel assembly **204** may also have a label **604** including graphics indicating the position of the knob with respect to the wheel, thus enabling each wheel to be easily set to the same tension as the others.

Referring back to FIGS. **2** and **3**, in one aspect, the handlebar assembly **235** is pivotally connected to the side panels **226** with a bolt **312** inserted through an aperture **316** in each leg channel and a mating aperture in the side panel **226**. A nut **318** attaches to each bolt **312** to hold each leg channel **234** in pivoting relation to the side panel **226**.

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Loosening the nut **318** from the bolt **312** allows the leg channel **234** to be pivoted in relation to the side panel **226** to a desired angular position and tightening the nut **318** to the bolt **312** retains the leg channel **234** with respect to the side panel **226**.

Alternately, with reference now to FIG. **4**, the handlebar assembly **235** is pivotally connected to the side panels **226** with a bolt **312** inserted through an aperture in the leg channel **234** and threaded into a tapped insert **402** affixed in the side panel **226**. Loosening the bolt **312** from the tapped insert **402** allows the leg channel **234** to be pivoted in relation to the side panel **226** to a desired angular position and tightening the bolt **312** to the tapped insert **402** retains the leg channel **234** with respect to the side panel **226**.

With reference to FIGS. **2** and **5**, the display device assembly **241** may include a crossbar **249** connected at each end to one of a pair of legs **242**, wherein each of the legs **242** is pivotally connected to the handlebar assembly **235** with a bolt **502** having threads **503** inserted through an aperture **504** in each leg channel **234** of the handlebar assembly **235** and a mating aperture **506** in each leg **242**. A nut **508** attaches to each bolt **502** to hold each leg **242** in pivoting relation to the leg channel **234**. Loosening the nut **508** from the bolt **502** allows the leg **242** to be pivoted in relation to the leg channel **234** to a desired angular position and tightening the nut **508** to the bolt **502** retains the leg **242** with respect to leg channel **234**.

Means for removably attaching a display device **250** for display to the toddler **209** as they direct movement of the walker along the surface may include a device bracket **252** for removably holding the display device **250**. The device bracket **252** has a pair of threaded device mounts **248** oppositely disposed to removably hold the display device **250**, and a pair of locking knobs **244**. Each of the locking knobs **244** threadedly engage each threaded mount **248** such that the position of each of the threaded mounts **248** can be selectively adjusted to accommodate differently sized display devices by moving towards or away from each other as desired.

Means for adjusting the height of the display device **250** may include a pair of nuts **510** for removably securing each of the threaded mounts **248** to the crossbar **249** through a slotted upright **246** attached to the crossbar. The device bracket **252** may be raised or lowered in relation to the crossbar **249** and the nuts **510** may be used to secure the device bracket **252** in a desired vertical position on the crossbar **249**.

By providing the various adjustments described above, the toddler walker can easily accommodate differently aged and sized toddlers, thus extending the useful life of the toddler walker as the toddler grows older, until the point where they no longer need or want to use the toddler walker. Thus, FIG. **7** is a side elevation of the toddler walker adjusted for use by a toddler **702** having a smaller stature; and FIG. **8** is a side elevation of the toddler walker adjusted for use by a toddler **802** having a larger stature.

FIG. **9** is a top perspective view of a second embodiment of a toddler walker that is similar to the first embodiment described above, the main difference being a modified display device assembly **908** that is independent of a modified handlebar assembly **904** and is slidably adjustable, rather than being pivotally connected to the connected to the handlebar assembly as in the first embodiment.

Thus, as with the first embodiment, the toddler walker includes a body **202** which has a bottom panel (not shown), and a front panel **224**, a rear panel **222**, and two side panels **226** attached to the bottom panel so as to form an open

box-like structure. At least four wheel assemblies **204** are provided, each including a wheel **205** rotatably affixed to the body **202** so that when the wheels **205** rotate the body **202** moves via the wheels along a surface.

A modified handlebar assembly **904** is provided in this second embodiment with a handlebar **232** and a pair of modified leg channels **902** pivotally connected to the side panels **226**, to enable a toddler to grasp the handlebar assembly **904** when located behind the body **202** and direct movement of the body along the surface. Also shown is a horn **906**, which may be electrical (battery powered) or mechanical as known in the art. The horn **906** may be used with any of the embodiments described herein.

As with the first embodiment, means are provided for adjusting the handlebar **232** to a desired vertical position, wherein the leg channels **902** are each slidably connected to a slotted member **236**, with the handlebar **232** being connected at each end to the slotted members **236**. The means for adjusting the handlebar to a desired vertical position include a bolt **310** inserted through an aperture (not shown) on the leg channel **902** and a slot **322** in the slotted member **236**, with a nut **320** attaching to the bolt **310** to hold the slotted member **236** in sliding relation to the leg channel **234**. Loosening the nut **320** from the bolt **310** allows the slotted member **236** to be raised or lowered in relation to the leg channel **234** and tightening the nut **320** to the bolt **310** retains the slotted member **236** with respect to the leg channel **234**.

As stated above, in this second embodiment, the modified display device assembly **908** is slidably connected to the side panels **226** and has means for removably attaching a display device **250** for display to the toddler **209** as they direct movement of the walker along the surface. As shown further in FIG. **10**, each side panel **26** has a slotted bracket **1006** with a slot **1008** for receiving therethrough a mount **1002** with a threaded stud, wherein a nut **1004** is threaded onto the threaded stud to secure the mount **1002** to the slotted bracket.

Also, in this second embodiment, the display device assembly **908** has a pivoting crossbar **920** attached at each end to one of a pair of legs **924**, wherein each of the legs **924** is pivotally connected to the side panels with a bolt **502** inserted through an aperture **506** in each leg **924** and a mating aperture in the mount **1002** secured to the side panel **226**. The bolt **502** is secured with a nut **508** and holds each leg **924** in pivoting relation to the mount **1002**. Loosening the nut **508** from the bolt **502** allows the leg **924** to be pivoted in relation to the mount **1002** to a desired angular position and tightening the nut **508** to the bolt **502** retains the leg **924** with respect to the mount **1002**.

In an alternative aspect of this embodiment, FIG. **11** is a local perspective view of the second embodiment of FIG. **9** showing a display device mount having height adjustability in addition to sliding capability. A slotted member **1104** is provided having a slot **1106**, selectively adjustable and held in place with respect to a modified leg **1102** using a bolt **1108** and mating nut (not shown).

Referring back to FIG. **9**, the modified display device assembly **908** has means for pivoting the crossbar **920** in relation to the legs **924**, which may include a bolt **922** inserted into an aperture in the crossbar and a mating aperture in the leg, the bolt **922** being secured by a nut (not shown). The crossbar **920** may be pivoted in relation to the legs **924** to provide the desired angular position of the display device.

In a third embodiment, as shown in FIG. **12**, the toddler walker is similar to the first and second embodiments but has

independent sliding capability for both the handlebar assembly and the display device assembly. Thus, as with the first embodiment, the toddler walker includes a body **202** which has a bottom panel (not shown), and a front panel **224**, a rear panel **222**, and two side panels **226** attached to the bottom panel so as to form an open box-like structure. At least four wheel assemblies **204** are provided, each including a wheel **205** rotatably affixed to the body **202** so that when the wheels **205** rotate the body **202** moves via the wheels along a surface.

A modified handlebar assembly **1230** is provided with a handlebar **232** and a pair of modified leg channels **1212** slidably and pivotally connected to the side panels **226** to enable a toddler to grasp the handlebar **232** when located behind the body and direct movement of the body along the surface. With reference to FIG. **13**, each side panel **226** has a slotted rail **1202** with a slot **1204** for receiving therethrough a mount **1206** with a threaded stud, wherein a nut **1208** is threaded onto the threaded stud to secure the mount **1206** where desired along the slotted rail **1202**. A pair of legs channels **1212** are pivotally connected to the mounts **1206** with a bolt **1210** having a threaded portion inserted through an aperture **1214** in each leg channel **1212** and a mating aperture in each mount **1206**, the threaded portion of the bolt being secured with a nut **1216**. Thus, the leg channel **1212** pivots in relation to the mount **1206** (and as described above the mount **1206** slides in relation to the slotted rail **1202**).

In this third embodiment, the modified display device assembly is substantially the same as that in the second embodiment described above with respect to FIG. **9**, in that it is slidably connected to the side panels **226** and has means for removably attaching a display device for display to the toddler as they direct movement of the walker along the surface, including means for adjusting the height of the display device. Instead of being located in a (smaller) slotted bracket **1006** as in FIG. **9**, the mounts **1002** are located in the longer slotted rail **1202** along with the modified handlebar assembly **1230**. With respect to FIG. **13**, the slot **1204** in the slotted rail **1202** receives therethrough the mount **1002** with a threaded stud, wherein a nut **1004** is threaded onto the threaded stud to secure the mount **1002** to the slotted bracket.

Each of the legs **924** is pivotally connected to the mount **1002** with a bolt **502** inserted through an aperture **506** in each leg **924** and a mating aperture in the mount **1002**. The bolt **502** is secured with a nut **508** and holds each leg **924** in pivoting relation to the mount **1002**. Loosening the nut **508** from the bolt **502** allows the leg **924** to be pivoted in relation to the mount **1002** to a desired angular position and tightening the nut **508** to the bolt **502** retains the leg **924** with respect to the mount **1002**.

With respect to all embodiments as described above, the entertainment and attention getting factor provided by the child's favorite video program presentation on the display device including familiar music, characters and learning animation is the key factor in increasing attention and commitment to by the child to working with the device.

What is claimed is:

1. A toddler walker comprising:

- a body comprising a bottom panel, and a front panel, a rear panel, and a pair of side panels attached to the bottom panel so as to form an open box;
- at least four wheel assemblies, each wheel assembly comprising
- a wheel rotatably affixed to the body so that when the wheels rotate the body moves via the wheels along a surface,

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a hub having a hub recess centered therein, and wherein the wheel of each wheel assembly is rotatably affixed to the body with an axle attached to the side panel, the axle comprising a threaded portion, wherein the wheel is coupled to the axle by inserting the threaded portion of the axle through the hub recess such that the hub rests against a bearing surface of the axle, and further wherein a knob is threaded onto the threaded portion of the axle to maintain the wheel rotatably on the axle;

means for adjusting the tension of the wheel comprising a lock washer inserted onto the threaded portion of the axle between the hub and the knob, the lock washer comprising biasing whereby tightening the knob urges the lock washer against the hub to increase friction against the hub and require increased strength to push the walker along the surface; and

a handlebar assembly comprising a handlebar, means for adjusting the handlebar to a desired vertical position, and a pair of leg channels pivotally connected to the side panels, to enable a toddler to grasp said handlebar assembly when located behind the body and direct movement of the body along the surface.

2. The toddler walker of claim 1 wherein each leg channel of the handlebar assembly is slidably connected to a slotted member, wherein the handlebar is connected at each end to

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the slotted members, and wherein the means for adjusting the handlebar to a desired vertical position comprises a bolt inserted through an aperture on the leg channel and a slot in the slotted member, wherein a nut attaches to the bolt to hold the slotted member in sliding relation to the leg channel, wherein loosening the nut from the bolt allows the slotted member to be raised or lowered in relation to the leg channel and tightening the nut to the bolt retains the slotted member with respect to the leg channel.

3. The toddler walker of claim 1 wherein the handlebar assembly is pivotally connected to the side panels with a bolt inserted through an aperture in each leg channel and a mating aperture in the side panel, wherein a nut attaches to each bolt to hold each leg channel in pivoting relation to the side panel, wherein loosening the nut from the bolt allows the leg channel to be pivoted in relation to the side panel to a desired angular position and tightening the nut to the bolt retains the leg channel with respect to the side panel.

4. The toddler walker of claim 1 wherein the handlebar assembly is pivotally connected to the side panels with a bolt inserted through an aperture in the leg channel and threaded into a tapped insert affixed in the side panel, wherein loosening the bolt from the tapped insert allows the leg channel to be pivoted in relation to the side panel to a desired angular position and tightening the bolt to the tapped insert retains the leg channel with respect to the side panel.

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